AIRCAT2517

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LEADER IN ADAPTIVE PREPARATION FOR CAT

AIRCAT-2517 Dissection

AIRCAT2517 would have been a welcome change for most of you – at least as far as VARC and QA are concerned. A relatively easier test in these 2 sections, and with no surprise in terms of pattern, it also meant that the cut-offs would be higher than normal for these 2 sections. However, the DILR section was designed to come across as extremely tough even though it had 2-3 very doable sets. Tests such as this one should also help you understand again that you cannot have a specific number of attempts in mind – for any section or overall – the ideal attempts and score are a function of the difficulty level of the section/test. An easier AIRCAT (or actual CAT for that matter) would necessitate a higher number of attempts and also a higher cut-off score and vice-versa. And your attempts infact will change automatically as per the difficulty level of the test, if you don't over analyse or make any basic mistake such as getting stuck on a single question/set for a long time.

Let us now look at a detailed sectional analysis in terms of (relative) difficulty level:

	Easy	Intermediate	Difficult	Difficulty Level	Cut off Questions (Marks)
Section I (VRC)	8	8	8	Easy to Intermediate	15 (28)
Section II (DILR)	1	5	16	Difficult	7 (12)
Section III (QA)	5	7	10	Intermediate	9 (17)
Overall	14	20	34	Intermediate	31 (58)

A higher proportion of easy and intermediate level questions, in the first and the third sections, meant the overall test was not as tough as the numbers would finally suggest. Upfront, the VRC section was easier and highly scoring whereas the QA section at the end needed some smart selection. One should have looked at VRC as the platform for maximization, and all it needed to do extremely well on the DILR section was to crack 2 sets. This of course assumes that you were well prepared and had clear basics in place to make use of it.

SECTION I: Verbal Ability & Reading Comprehension (VRC)

The first passage about the electricity grid was a very doable one, except for one tricky question. The second passage-questions combination – the passage was about decision-making by managers – was broadly of an intermediate level, and could have been considered towards the end of the time for this section. The third passage, the one questioning our being alone in the Galaxy (questions 17-20) was perhaps trickier than it seemed given its small size and comprehensible language. The last passage (questions 21-24) was on the easier side, but having at the end would have caused many of you to rush and make mistakes in the process.

While the Para-jumbles in 12-14 were lengthy, they were effectively MCQs and smart use of choices made them fairly doable with no downside of negative marking to boot. Among questions 15-16 on Out of Context, there were no sitters.

Around 20 attempts with 15 correct would have got you a score of 40+, and a score of 45+ was definitely on the cards for those of you with a good command on the language and the ability to eliminate wrong options. A score of around 30 would have helped you clear the cut-offs for the section.

SECTION II: Data Interpretation & Logical Reasoning (DILR)
The section, coming as it was after an easy VARC, would have seen extreme frustration and time wastage for most of you. With no easy sets on offer as you began to browse through and maybe dipstick some sets. The absence of Non-MCQs would not have provided any solace either.

As shared earlier, the crucial part in such a tough section (or a test) is to relax, adapt and do your best rather than wonder if you are the only one up against it. You surge ahead of many others, who will perhaps panic, simply by staying calm.

All that this section needed was for you to crack 2 sets, maybe with even 1 question wrong. As mentioned earlier, the section was 'designed' to appear tougher than it actually was. So, instead of tough, it would have appeared very tough.

SECTION III: Quantitative Ability (QA)
While the section was not too difficult overall, the first 7 questions were certainly tough in the sense that could have acted as a speed breaker for those among you who were a little tired and also a wee bit complacent after having done well in the first 2 (relatively easier) sections. Most questions from 8 onwards were doable.

8 attempts with 6 correct also would have sufficed to help you clear the cut-offs. At the same time, your score should have been much higher (30+) if you were not tired (this being the last section) or complacent.

Summary:

Tentative sectional and overall benchmarks are given below:

	98%ile	**95%ile**	**90%ile**	**85%ile**
Section I (VRC)	38	32	27	24
Section II (DILR)	18	15	11	8
Section III (QA)	27	19	15	13
Overall	62	52	45	41

Disclaimer: The above analysis is *generic* and cannot factor in your individual strengths and weaknesses beyond a point and hence please interpret it to suit your specific Adaptability!

-AIRCAT Spinner Team (AST)